During an exploratory phase, Meinerding adapted Captain America's iconic chain mail from the comic books into a practical design. "I'm a huge fan of Cap's traditional scale armor, and I've always wanted to make it work," he explains. "When Tony Stark conceptually started being the one designing and building the Avengers' costumes, that costume felt a little more possible in the worlds we were making. Practically, it's a challenge to accomplish without feeling like it's something you've seen before. This was an attempt in doing that kind of armor, but in a more tactical and modern way. I focused on creating pointy U-shapes with more hard-edged angles to make it feel a bit more tough and read as bulletproof instead of just shiny scales. The other design part of it is that each one of the scales are designed to fit around the star, which is the classic look. The star is simply cut into the U-shape—I was trying to design something that sort of fits together perfectly instead of cutting a shape out of a bunch of U-shaped scales."

Ryan Meinerding concept art.